

ASUS P4B266

Excellent Design

ASUS P4B266 is a DDR solution based on the Intel 82845D North Bridge and 82801BA South Bridge chipsets. The board is bundled with a CMEDIA audio chip capable of six-channel audio output and on-board support for reading smart card and memory stick.

The board's performance was at least 25 per cent lower than the RDRAM solution in most tests, but it managed to overtake the RDRAM score by a good margin in the CPU Dhrystone (MIPS) and Whetstone (MFLOPS) tests.

It has a neat design and boasts efficient component and connector layouts. For example, the floppy drive connector is turned 90 degrees to allow for easy connectivity of the cable. The P4B266 is USB 2.0 ready and has six PCI slots, 4x AGP support and one CNR slot. The

board came bundled with the USB 2.0 module, S/PDIF module, software CD and a detailed setup and user guide. The ASUS MyLogo is automatically installed with the ASUS update utility and lets you flash the BIOS without any hassles. EZ Plug lets you use your old ATX power supply because the board is fitted with the auxiliary four-pin 12V connector.

This saves additional expenses on power supply for a P4 board. The price is well worth its features and performance.

SPECIFICATIONS

Intel 845D chipset, can support up to 2 GB of PC2100/PC1600 DDR-RAM, CMEDIA audio chip capable of six-channel audio output, Intel 10/100 Mbps LAN controller and on-board support for reading smart card and memory stick, six PCI, 4x AGP and 1 CNR slot

Price: Rs 13,500

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Web site: www.asus.com.tw

ASUS P4B266		A-
Performance	★★★★	
Build Quality	★★★★	
Value for Money	★★★★ 1/2	
Features	★★★★	
OVERALL	★★★★	

UMAX Astra 4500

A Cheap Home Solution

Astra 4500 is a 1200x2400 dpi scanner from UMAX with a 48-bit depth. The scanner is slim and light but has a high warm-up time of 30 seconds. The scanner took 5.6 seconds to pre-view the test image at 200 dpi and took 1 minute 8 seconds to scan the same image at 300 dpi in full colour mode. The scanner, compared to others in its category, is slow and took a lot more time to

scan the IT8 card at 600 dpi in full colour mode. When checked against the test image, we found that the scanner did not reproduce



original colour and wasn't even able to capture the colour tones properly. The TWAIN driver of the scanner is simple enough to use but the icons are not intuitive and will need getting used to. The scanner came bundled with the TWAIN driver, ScanSoft OCR software, MGI PhotoSuite SE and PaperCom Document Manager. Home users who

Price: Rs 11,750

Contact: Neoteric Informatique

Phone: 022-4172600

E-mail: sales@neoteric-info.com

Web site: www.umax.com

occasionally have to scan documents or images will find the Astra 4500 a cheap solution.

SPECIFICATIONS

1200x2400 dpi capable, 48-bit depth

Benchmarks: 30 second warm up time, 5.6 second preview time at 200 dpi, 1 minute 8 seconds at 300 dpi

UMAX Astra 4500		B
Performance	★★★★	
Build Quality	★★★★	
Value for Money	★★★★ 1/2	
Features	★★★★	
OVERALL	★★★★	

PC BOOSTER 1.0

Fast and Painless

You've probably noticed your PC running slower than you'd like and wished at times that something could be done to increase the speed without having to delve into the intricacies of registry editing. PC BOOST-

ER 1.0 is an application that can make you a pro at tweaking the performance of your machine. This small utility (1.3 MB download size) from Incline Global (www.incline-global.com) has a plethora of options for tweaking the system, desktop, Start Menu, Internet, disk drives, memory as well as boot up and shut down. This utility literally takes care of the entire system.



Some of the features

Price: Shareware \$29.95 (approx rs 1,467)

Web site: www.inclineglobal.com

tested that made a real difference in the performance of the hard disk were disk caching, which can change the cache size up to 2 MB, and enabling of FIFO (First In First Out) mode for applications that read and write randomly, thereby increasing the overall performance of the machine.

For speeding up the Internet, it provides you with various options including deletion of cookies, clearing of temporary Internet files as well as tweaking MTU (Maximum Transmission Unit) and RWIN (Receive Windows) settings.

SPECIFICATIONS

System Requirements: Windows 95/98/Me/NT/2000, 3.46 MB install size

PC Booster 1.0		B+
Performance	★★★★ 1/2	
Ease of use	★★★★	
Value for Money	★★★★ 1/2	
Features	★★★★ 1/2	
OVERALL	★★★★ 1/2	